

Healthy Food Swaps

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 04, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/SFsSdfQBSEE> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter gives direct, opinionated food swap advice for four common cravings, consistently pushing toward protein-first eating and cutting out processed carbs and sugars.

Contents

-  Swap 1: Snickers Bar → Almonds
-  Swap 2: Empanadas → Ground Beef (Lettuce Wrap)
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Swap 1: Snickers Bar → Almonds 0:00

- Craving: Snickers bar
- Swap: **Almonds**
 - Carter dismisses candy bars as food "only for women and children"
 - His reasoning: kids can burn off the sugar; adults (specifically men) cannot justify it
 - Tone is deliberately blunt and provocative

Swap 2: Empanadas → Ground Beef (Lettuce Wrap) 0:10

- Craving: Empanadas
- Swap: **Ground beef**, optionally in a lettuce wrap
 - Carter calls empanadas a "high ideal meal" and addresses the audience as "mi gente" (my people)
 - The swap keeps the protein filling of a traditional empanada while ditching the dough/pastry shell
 - Lettuce wrap is offered as an optional low-carb vessel

Swap 3: Bagel with Cream Cheese → Greek Yogurt with Berries 0:21

- Craving: Bagel with cream cheese
- Swap: **Greek yogurt with berries mixed in**
 - Replaces a refined-carb, low-protein breakfast staple with a higher-protein, lower-carb alternative
 - No additional reasoning given beyond the straight swap

Swap 4: Hawaiian Bread at Family Dinner → Protein-First Strategy [0:27](#)

- Craving: Hawaiian bread at a family gathering
- Swap: No direct food replacement — instead a **behavioral/meal-order strategy**
 - Carter's personal approach: eat protein and vegetables first until full
 - Once full on protein and vegetables, the desire for bread and other sides disappears naturally
 - His characterization of wanting the bread: "Does this person have no discipline?"
 - Underlying principle: use satiety from quality food to crowd out less nutritious options, rather than relying on willpower alone